eDiscovery Readiness Assessment — Microsoft Purview

Implementation Solution Guide

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Executive Summary — eDiscovery Readiness Assessment (Microsoft Purview)

Outcome

Your organization has an **evidenced, defensible answer to "if a legal hold or regulatory request landed today, could we respond?"** Instead of discovering gaps mid-litigation, you hold a **readiness scorecard** across four domains — **roles, holds/preservation, data-source scope, and process** — a **prioritized gap register** with owners, and **proof** that the capability actually works: a hold placed, a search run, and preservation confirmed on a **dedicated test account**, then cleaned up. The gaps that quietly break real matters — over-privileged or unstaffed roles, an audit log that is off, uncovered inactive mailboxes, missing Teams/M365-Group scope, no intake or sign-off process — are found and fixed **before** the stakes are real.

Approach

The assessment follows a pilot-first model — **Assess** → **Design** → **Configure** → **Pilot (readiness proof in test)** → **Validate** → **Expand.** It inventories the current state read-only, scores each domain **Not Ready** → **Partial** → **Ready** into a scorecard and gap register, remediates **dry-run first** (enabling the audit log, putting operators in the least-privilege **eDiscovery Manager/Administrator** role groups, adopting the intake/naming/change-control artifacts), and then **rehearses the capability non-destructively** on a scratch test account — create case, place hold, run search, confirm preservation, **remove the hold**. Everything is named to a standard (`eDiscovery Readiness – Proof – Pilot`) and the same names flow through the tests and the five included PowerShell tools. It is deliberately distinct from **operating** matters — a separate eDiscovery Administration solution runs real cases end to end; this one makes you **ready** to.

Why it is low-risk

- **Legal owns the determination; IT proves the capability.** Scope, custodians, holds, and production are legal/records decisions — this solution supplies the technical readiness evidence, never the legal call. The proof runs on a **test account**, never a real custodian.
- **Non-destructive and self-cleaning.** The readiness proof places a hold on a test mailbox and **removes it** at the end; nothing real is preserved, and the tenant is left as it was.
- **Least-privilege by design.** Roles are assessed and remediated to the **eDiscovery role groups**, not Global Admin, with coverage so no single person is a point of failure.
- **Safe-by-default automation.** Four of the five tools are **read-only**; the remediation tool is `-WhatIf` **by default** and requires an explicit `-Commit` — modern authentication, **no credentials or secrets in code.**

The result is a capability you can **prove is ready** — least-privilege, defensible, and rehearsed — at a fraction of the cost of finding out during litigation that it was not.

1. Solution Overview — eDiscovery Readiness Assessment (Microsoft Purview)

What this solution is (and is not)

This solution answers one question with evidence: **"If a legal hold or regulatory request landed today, could we respond — completely, defensibly, and on time?"** It is a **readiness assessment** of your Microsoft Purview eDiscovery capability across four domains — **roles, holds/preservation, data-source scope, and process** — that produces a **readiness scorecard, a prioritized gap register, and a remediation roadmap**, then **proves** the capability with a small, non-destructive **readiness-proof pilot** on a test account.

> ***This is an *assessment*, not the day-to-day operation of matters.*** *A separate Purview solution — **eDiscovery Administration** — covers running real matters end to end (case → search → hold → review → export, with KQL query design, review sets, analytics, and defensible export). This readiness assessment sits *before* that: it confirms you are configured, licensed, staffed, and rehearsed to run matters at all, and it fixes the gaps that would otherwise surface mid-litigation. Where operating a matter is in scope, use the eDiscovery Administration solution; this one makes you **ready** to.*

Why readiness is the risk

When a hold lands, the clock starts and the standard of conduct is **defensibility** — proof that preservation was timely and complete. Organizations fail here not because Purview cannot do it, but because of gaps that were invisible until tested:

- **Roles** granted through Global Administrator (over-privileged) or held by one person (no coverage), or nobody in **eDiscovery Manager/Administrator** at all.
- **Preservation** that silently is not working — the **unified audit log is off** (no defensibility evidence), **inactive/legacy mailboxes** are not covered, or retention and holds interact in ways nobody has verified.
- **Scope** blind spots — Teams messages (which live in mailboxes), M365 Group/Teams sites, OneDrive, unindexed or partially-indexed content — that make a collection incomplete.
- **Process** gaps — no matter-intake step, no legal sign-off gate, no naming standard, no change-control or evidence-pack routine — so the *first* real matter is improvised.

A readiness assessment surfaces these on a test account and a scorecard, not during discovery in a live matter.

The four readiness domains (the rubric)

Each domain is scored **Not Ready** → **Partial** → **Ready** with named, evidenced criteria:

1. **Roles & least privilege (R).** Are operators in **eDiscovery Manager**, with a small **eDiscovery Administrator** lead group, and **no standing Global Admin** used for matters? Is there **coverage** (more than one trained operator — no single point of failure)? Are compliance boundaries

considered where separation is required?

1. **Holds & preservation (H).** Is the **unified audit log on** (the defensibility evidence)? Can a

hold actually preserve — proven, not assumed? Are **inactive/legacy mailboxes**, **litigation-hold** state, and **retention-vs-hold interplay** understood and covered? Is there headroom for the number/size of holds you may need?

1. **Data-source scope & coverage (S).** Are all in-scope **workloads** discoverable — Exchange

(including **Teams chat**, which lives in mailboxes), SharePoint, OneDrive, and **Teams/M365 Group sites and files**? Are **unindexed/partially-indexed** items and any third-party/imported data accounted for?

1. **Process & defensibility (P).** Is there a **matter-intake** step with a named **legal/records

owner **who determines scope and holds; a** naming standard**;** change control **and** rollback **for holds/exports; and an** evidence-pack** routine (who keeps the audit trail and export reports)?

How it works (the assessment model)

1. **Assess (read-only).** Inventory the current state — role membership, existing cases/holds, audit

status, licensing signals, inactive mailboxes, retention holds, and workload coverage — with the included read-only scripts. Nothing changes.

1. **Design (the scorecard).** Score each domain against the rubric, record every gap in the **gap

register** with severity and owner, and design the target state and remediation order.

1. **Configure/Remediate (simulation/test first).** Close gaps — add operators to the correct role

groups, enable the audit log, stand up the naming standard and intake process — using the remediation script **dry-run (**`-WhatIf`**) by default**, committing only with an explicit switch.

1. **Pilot the readiness proof (non-destructive, on a test account).** Prove the capability end to

end on a **scratch, non-sensitive test account**: create a **readiness-proof case**, place a **hold**, run a **scoped search**, confirm preservation, then **remove the proof hold**. This rehearses the muscle without touching real custodians — the "pilot in test" gate.

1. **Validate (pass/fail gates).** Re-run the validation script; every rubric gate must pass and the

audit log must show the proof activity.

1. **Expand (operate).** With gaps closed and the proof passing, you are ready to run live matters —

using the **eDiscovery Administration** solution — with legal owning every determination.

The reference design (naming)

Everything created by the readiness proof is named to make it obvious it is a **rehearsal**, and is removed at the end:

- Proof case: `eDiscovery Readiness – Proof – Pilot`
- Proof hold policy / rule: `Readiness Hold Policy – Proof – Pilot` / `Readiness Hold Rule – Proof – Pilot`
- Proof search: `Readiness Search – Proof – Pilot`

• Proof custodian: a **dedicated test account** (placeholder `readiness-pilot@contoso.com`), never a

real person.

What legal owns (and what this solution does not decide)

Regulatory, records-retention, and legal determinations are deferred to your compliance, records, privacy, and legal functions. This solution supplies the **technical method and the evidence** — whether roles are least-privilege, whether a hold preserves, whether scope is complete — but never the legal call about what must be held, who is a custodian, what a retention schedule is, or whether a regulatory obligation applies. The readiness proof runs on a **test account only**; it is a capability rehearsal, not a real preservation.

Benefits

• **Know before litigation, not during.** A defensible, evidenced answer to "are we ready?" — with a scorecard the business and legal can act on.

• **Fixes the invisible gaps.** Over-privileged roles, audit-off tenants, uncovered inactive mailboxes, and missing process — found on a test account, not mid-matter.

• **Least-privilege and safe.** Remediation is dry-run by default; the proof is non-destructive and self-cleaning; no Global Admin dependency.

• **A rehearsed muscle.** The team has actually placed a hold and run a search once, in test, before the stakes are real.

Limitations (be honest with buyers)

• **Licensing-gated capability.** Content Search and eDiscovery (Standard) cases/holds are broadly available; **eDiscovery (Premium)** (custodians, review sets, analytics, structured export) requires **Microsoft 365 E5 / E5 eDiscovery and Audit** — the assessment reports which tier is available; **verify your licensing/tenant.** Readiness for *Premium* review workflows is flagged where the tier is absent.

• **The portal is evolving.** Microsoft unified the eDiscovery experience in the Purview portal (`purview.microsoft.com`); menu paths differ from older screenshots — paths are flagged **"verify in your tenant."**

• **Not a substitute for legal judgement.** The assessment evidences capability; scope, custodian, hold, and production decisions remain legal/records determinations.

• **Government clouds differ.** GCC High / DoD use different portal hosts (e.g. `*.office365.us`) and some features lag Commercial — **verify in your tenant.**

The standard deployment model

Assess → Design → Configure → Pilot (readiness proof in test) → Validate → Expand. *Remediation is dry-run first; the readiness proof is non-destructive and runs on a dedicated test account; every gate is explicit pass/fail with a documented rollback (remove the proof hold, revert role changes).*

2. Requirements Guide — eDiscovery Readiness Assessment (Microsoft Purview)

These are the prerequisites to run the **assessment and the readiness proof**. They complement — and do **not** repeat — the six shared **[Purview category Global Requirements](global-requirements-purview.md)** (compliance licensing, least-privilege Purview roles, S&C PowerShell + Graph toolchain, in-scope data sources, compliance/records/legal stakeholders, and a pilot scope + change control). Verify each of the six there first; the solution-specific items below add the eDiscovery detail. Each entry is **Description · Why · Verify · Implement-if-missing.**

2.1 eDiscovery tier / licensing known (Standard vs Premium)

Description: Confirmation of which eDiscovery tier the tenant is licensed for. **Content Search** and **eDiscovery (Standard)** cases and holds are available in most enterprise plans (e.g. Microsoft 365 E3); **eDiscovery (Premium)** — custodians, review sets, analytics/de-duplication, structured export — requires **Microsoft 365 E5** or the **E5 eDiscovery and Audit** add-on (see category GR #1). **Why:** Readiness for a Premium *review* workflow cannot be asserted without the Premium tier; the assessment must record the tier so the scorecard reflects real capability, not aspiration. **Verify:** Microsoft 365 admin center → **Billing** → **Licenses**; open `https://purview.microsoft.com` → **eDiscovery** — if you cannot create custodians/review sets you are on Standard only. Run `EDREADY-Discovery.ps1` (reports which case types/holds exist). **Plan names and gating change — verify in your tenant. Implement:** Record the tier in the scorecard. If Premium review capability is required and absent, assign E5 / E5 eDiscovery and Audit before claiming Premium readiness.

2.2 eDiscovery role groups (least privilege) — the assessor's access

Description: The assessor needs at least **eDiscovery Manager** to read cases/searches and place the proof hold, and visibility of **eDiscovery Administrator** membership; reading role membership needs an appropriate Purview role (category GR #2). No Global Administrator is used to run the proof. **Why:** The assessment evaluates *whether roles are least-privilege*; the assessor themselves must operate through the role groups, modelling the target state. **Verify:** `https://purview.microsoft.com` → **Settings** → **Roles & scopes** → **Permissions** → **Microsoft Purview solutions** → **eDiscovery Manager / eDiscovery Administrator**; or PowerShell `Get-RoleGroupMember "eDiscovery Manager"` / `Get-RoleGroupMember "eDiscovery Administrator"`. Run `EDREADY-Discovery.ps1`. **Implement:** Add the assessor to **eDiscovery Manager** (and note the current membership as an assessment finding). Do **not** grant Global Admin for the assessment.

2.3 Unified audit log enabled (defensibility evidence)

Description: The Microsoft Purview **unified audit log** is on, so case, search, hold, and export activity — including the readiness proof — is recorded. **Why:** The audit trail *is* the evidence of defensibility. A tenant

with auditing **off** is a high-severity readiness gap: preservation actions cannot be proven after the fact. **Verify:** Purview → **Audit** returns results; or `EDREADY-Discovery.ps1` reads `UnifiedAuditLogIngestionEnabled`. **Implement:** Enable auditing (the remediation script can do this with `-Commit`), then allow time for events to populate. Turning auditing on is itself a scored remediation item.

2.4 Data-source scope mapped (workloads + inactive mailboxes)

Description: A written map of the workloads a matter would have to cover — **Exchange** mailboxes (remembering **Teams chat** is stored in mailboxes), **SharePoint** sites, **OneDrive** accounts, and **Teams / M365 Group** sites and files — plus an inventory of **inactive/legacy mailboxes** and any third-party/imported data (extends category GR #4). **Why:** Coverage blind spots (Teams messages, M365 Group sites, inactive mailboxes) are the classic cause of incomplete collection; readiness means these are known *before* a matter. **Verify:** A scope note lists the workloads and any out-of-scope items; `EDREADY-Scope.ps1` reports mailbox coverage, litigation-hold state, and inactive mailboxes. **Implement:** Enumerate the workloads and inactive mailboxes; capture the map as a scorecard input.

2.5 Named legal/records owner + intake process (scope & hold determination)

Description: A named legal, compliance, or records owner who **decides** matter scope, custodians, holds, and production, and a **matter-intake step** where that sign-off is captured before any configuration (this is the eDiscovery-specific expression of category GR #5). **Why:** Scope and hold are **legal determinations**, not IT defaults. Readiness is not just technical — an org with perfect tooling but no intake/sign-off process is **not ready**. **Verify:** A matter-intake template/record exists with a named legal owner and a hold-instruction field. Confirmed with the stakeholder, recorded as a Process-domain finding. **Implement:** Establish the intake step (legal signs off scope + hold before configuration). Absence is a scored Process gap; the assessment provides the target-state description.

2.6 PowerShell modules and connectivity

Description: The **ExchangeOnlineManagement** module (provides **Security & Compliance PowerShell** `Connect-IPPSSession` **and** Exchange Online `Connect-ExchangeOnline`, used by the scope/mailbox checks) and, for Premium signals, the **Microsoft.Graph.Security** module (category GR #3). **Why:** The five scripts run through these — compliance objects via S&C PowerShell, mailbox/inactive coverage via Exchange Online, optional Premium case status via Graph. Graph cmdlet parameters are version-dependent — **verify in your tenant. Verify:** `Get-Module -ListAvailable ExchangeOnlineManagement, Microsoft.Graph.Security`; `Connect-IPPSSession` and `Connect-ExchangeOnline` succeed with modern auth (MFA). **Implement:** `Install-Module ExchangeOnlineManagement -Scope CurrentUser` and `Install-Module Microsoft.Graph.Security -Scope CurrentUser`. **Modern auth only — no stored credentials or app secrets in scripts.**

2.7 Dedicated test account for the readiness proof (non-sensitive)

Description: A **dedicated, non-sensitive test account** (for example an IT scratch mailbox) with a little seeded mail/files, used as the **proof custodian** so the full case → hold → search → confirm →

remove-hold rehearsal never touches a real person. **Why:** The readiness proof is a **capability rehearsal**; it must run in test. Using a real custodian would place a real hold — out of scope for an assessment and a legal action in its own right. **Verify:** A test account exists (placeholder `readiness-pilot@contoso.com`) with seeded content. **Implement:** Provision the test account, seed a few messages/files, and reserve the proof names from Section 1's reference design.

2.8 Change control + rollback for the proof (and for remediation)

Description: A change record covering the readiness-proof hold and any remediation (role-group changes, enabling audit), with a defined rollback (remove the proof hold/policy, revert role membership) — the eDiscovery expression of category GR #6. **Why:** Even a test hold and role changes are configuration changes in a production tenant; they need an approver, a pilot gate, and a documented rollback. **Verify:** A change ticket names the approver, the test scope, and the rollback steps. **Implement:** Record the change; run remediation `-WhatIf` first; place the proof hold only after sign-off; remove it at the end of the proof.

Checklist

- Category GR #1–#6 verified (licensing, roles, toolchain, data scope, stakeholders, pilot/change control)
- eDiscovery **tier** known (Standard vs **Premium/E5**) — `EDREADY-Discovery.ps1` — *verify in tenant*
- Assessor in **eDiscovery Manager**; **eDiscovery Administrator** membership reviewed; no Global Admin for the proof
- **Unified audit log** status checked (on = ready; off = high-severity gap) — `EDREADY-Discovery.ps1`
- Workloads + **inactive mailboxes** mapped — `EDREADY-Scope.ps1`
- Named **legal/records owner** + **matter-intake** process on record
- Modules installed (`ExchangeOnlineManagement`, `Microsoft.Graph.Security`); modern auth works
- **Dedicated test account** for the readiness proof (non-sensitive, seeded)
- Change control + rollback for the proof hold and remediation

Global Requirements — Microsoft Purview Solutions

These requirements apply to **every** solution in the **Purview** category (implementing and managing Microsoft Purview, sensitivity & retention labels, DLP, data lifecycle & records, insider risk, communication compliance, audit, data security posture management, and data governance). Verify each before starting a solution's implementation steps.

> ***Vendor boundary (applies to every Purview solution).*** *The **Microsoft Purview portal** (purview.microsoft.com), the **Microsoft 365 admin center**, **Security & Compliance PowerShell** (`Connect-IPPSSession`), and **Microsoft Graph** are authored at exact, current click-by-click / cmdlet detail from Microsoft's public documentation. Microsoft Purview features are heavily **licensing-/plan-dependent** (many require **Microsoft 365 E5** or the **E5 Compliance** add-on; some are*

*in preview) and the portal is **actively evolving** — capability availability and portal paths are **cited or flagged "verify your licensing/tenant"**, never asserted or invented. **Regulatory, records-retention, and legal determinations** (retention schedules, records file plans, legal holds, insider-risk case actions, regulatory applicability) are **deferred to the organization's compliance, records, privacy, and legal functions** — the solutions provide the technical configuration method and evidence, not the determination. Automation is **PowerShell** (Security & Compliance PowerShell / Graph) — never with hardcoded credentials or secrets.*

1. Microsoft 365 tenant with the required Purview/compliance licensing

• **Description:** A Microsoft 365 tenant with the **compliance licensing** the capability requires

(E3 for baseline; **E5 / E5 Compliance** for advanced DLP, auto-labeling, insider risk, communication compliance, Audit Premium, DSPM, etc.).

• **Why required:** Most Purview capabilities are plan-gated; the feature won't be available without the

right plan.

• **How to verify:** In the M365 admin center confirm the subscription/add-ons; check the feature is

visible in the Purview portal.

• **How to implement if missing:** Assign/purchase the required licensing before starting.

2. Purview roles (least-privilege) and portal access

• **Description:** Access with the least-privilege **Purview / compliance role** the solution names

(e.g. Compliance Administrator, Compliance Data Administrator, Information Protection, Records Management, Insider Risk, eDiscovery, Audit roles), with Global Administrator only where required.

• **Why required:** Purview uses fine-grained role groups; configuration requires the matching role.

• **How to verify:** Purview portal → **Roles & scopes / Permissions** — confirm the role membership.

• **How to implement if missing:** Assign the least-privilege role group under change control.

3. Security & Compliance PowerShell + Graph toolchain

• **Description:** A workstation with **Security & Compliance PowerShell** (`Connect-IPPSSession` via the

ExchangeOnlineManagement module) and **Microsoft Graph PowerShell**, modern-auth / MFA-capable admin.

• **Why required:** Configuration, automation, and the provided scripts run through these.

• **How to verify:** `Connect-IPPSSession` and `Connect-MgGraph` succeed with the admin account.

• **How to implement if missing:** Install the modules and confirm modern-auth sign-in before running steps.

4. Data sources & scope in scope

• **Description:** The **workloads and data sources** in scope (Exchange, SharePoint, OneDrive, Teams,

endpoints/devices, and — for data governance — the broader data estate) and a **data-classification / sensitivity** intent to drive labels, DLP, and retention.

- **Why required:** Purview policies key off the in-scope workloads and the classification scheme.
- **How to verify:** Confirm the in-scope workloads and the classification/sensitivity approach with

stakeholders.

- **How to implement if missing:** Define the scope and classification intent before authoring policies.

5. Compliance, records, privacy & legal stakeholders

- **Description:** Engagement with the **compliance, records-management, privacy, security, and legal**

stakeholders whose policies the configuration must satisfy (retention schedules, records file plans, regulatory obligations, insider-risk and communication-compliance policy, legal hold).

- **Why required:** Purview configuration must align to enterprise policy and legal/records requirements,

not technical defaults; several capabilities have HR/legal sensitivity.

- **How to verify:** Confirm the applicable policies, the records schedule, and named approvers.
- **How to implement if missing:** Identify the owners and capture the requirements before configuring.

6. A pilot scope and change control

- **Description:** A **pilot scope** (users/sites/policies in simulation or a limited ring) to validate

on before tenant-wide enforcement, and a **change-control** process — most Purview policies support a **simulation / test / disabled** mode that MUST be used before enforcement.

- **Why required:** Every solution follows an **Assess → Design → Configure → Pilot (simulate) → Validate

→ Expand (enforce)** model; DLP, labels, retention, and insider-risk changes are high-impact.

- **How to verify:** Confirm a named pilot scope, that simulation/test mode is available, and a change

window/approval path.

- **How to implement if missing:** Define the pilot and agree change control before enforcing anything.

*The deployment model across every Purview solution is the same: **Assess** → **Design** → **Configure** → **Pilot (simulate/test)** → **Validate** → **Expand (enforce)**, with explicit pass/fail gates and a documented rollback. Automation is delivered as **PowerShell** (Security & Compliance PowerShell / Graph) — never with hardcoded credentials or secrets. Regulatory/records/legal determinations are deferred to the relevant governance functions.*

3. Implementation Guide — eDiscovery Readiness Assessment (Microsoft Purview)

Follow the model **Assess** → **Design** → **Configure** → **Pilot (readiness proof in test)** → **Validate** → **Expand.** The assessment scores four domains — **Roles (R)**, **Holds/preservation (H)**, **Scope/coverage (S)**, **Process (P)** — each **Not Ready** → **Partial** → **Ready**, records every gap in a **gap register**, remediates **dry-run first**, and then **proves** the capability non-destructively on a **dedicated test account**. Every proof artifact uses the Section 1 naming and the same names flow through Testing, Troubleshooting, and the scripts.

Portal: `https://purview.microsoft.com` → **eDiscovery** / **Audit** / **Settings** → **Roles & scopes** (Government clouds use a different host, e.g. `*.office365.us` — **verify in your tenant**). PowerShell: `Connect-IPPSSession` (Security & Compliance) for compliance objects; `Connect-ExchangeOnline` for mailbox/inactive coverage; `Microsoft.Graph.Security` for optional Premium signals.

> ***Legal owns the determination*** *of scope, custodians, holds, and production. Everything below is the technical assessment method and a* ***test-account rehearsal*** *— not a real matter, not a real preservation. Do not place a hold on a real custodian as part of this assessment.*

Stage A — Assess (read-only, nothing changes)

1. **Inventory current state.** Run `EDREADY-Discovery.ps1` (read-only). It reports: eDiscovery

role-group membership (Manager/Administrator) and whether Global Admin appears in either; existing **cases**, **Content Searches**, and **case-hold policies/rules**; **unified audit log** status; and case-type signals for the **tier** (Standard vs Premium). This feeds domains **R** and **H**.

1. **Map data-source coverage.** Run `EDREADY-Scope.ps1` (read-only). It reports mailbox count and

litigation-hold state, **inactive/legacy mailboxes**, and any existing retention holds, and lists the workloads to confirm (Exchange incl. **Teams chat in mailboxes**, SharePoint, OneDrive, Teams/M365 Group sites). This feeds domain **S**.

1. **Interview for process.** With the named legal/records owner (Requirement 2.5), confirm whether a

matter-intake step, **naming standard**, **change control/rollback**, and **evidence-pack** routine exist. This feeds domain **P**.

Gate A (pass/fail): discovery + scope reports captured and the process interview complete — you have the raw current state for all four domains. Fail → resolve access/module gaps (Requirements 2.2, 2.6) and re-run.

Stage B — Design (the scorecard + gap register)

1. **Score each domain against the rubric.** Using the Stage-A evidence, score **R/H/S/P** as **Not

Ready / Partial / Ready** with the named criteria:

• **R — Roles:** operators in **eDiscovery Manager**; a small **eDiscovery Administrator** lead

group; **no standing Global Admin** for matters; **coverage** ≥ **2** trained operators.

• **H — Holds/preservation: audit log on**; a hold can be **proven** to preserve (Stage D);

inactive mailboxes and **litigation-hold**/retention interplay understood and covered.

• **S — Scope/coverage:** all in-scope workloads discoverable, **Teams messages and M365 Group

sites **included,** unindexed/imported** data accounted for.

• **P — Process: matter-intake + legal sign-off**, **naming standard**, **change

control/rollback**,** evidence-pack** ownership all present.

1. **Record every gap.** For each below-Ready criterion, add a **gap-register** row: domain, finding,

severity (High/Med/Low), owner, and remediation action. Audit-off and Global-Admin-for-matters are **High** by default.

1. **Design the target state and order.** Sequence remediation: enable audit and fix roles first

(they gate everything and the proof), then scope/process. `EDREADY-Reporting.ps1` renders the scorecard + gap register.

Gate B: a completed scorecard and a prioritized gap register with owners. Fail → gather missing evidence and re-score.

Stage C — Configure / Remediate (simulation/-WhatIf first)

1. **Remediate the gaps — dry-run by default.** Run `EDREADY-Remediation.ps1` with `-WhatIf`

(the default) to preview every change; re-run with `-Commit` only after sign-off (Requirement 2.8). It can:

• **Enable the unified audit log** (`Set-AdminAuditLogConfig -UnifiedAuditLogIngestionEnabled

$true`) — closing the highest-severity H gap.

• **Add named operators** to **eDiscovery Manager** / the **eDiscovery Administrator** lead group

(`Add-RoleGroupMember`) — closing R gaps and building coverage.

• **Stand up the readiness-proof case + hold** shell (see Stage D) named to the Section 1 pattern.

It **never removes** holds or role members silently, and it prints every action it would take.

1. **Adopt the process artifacts.** Put the **matter-intake template**, **naming standard**, and

change-control/rollback and **evidence-pack** routine in place (documentation deliverables) — closing P gaps. These need no tenant change, only adoption.

Gate C: audit log **on**; role groups least-privilege with coverage; process artifacts adopted. Fail → complete remediation (re-run `-WhatIf`, then `-Commit`).

Stage D — Pilot: the readiness proof (non-destructive, test account only)

Prove the capability end to end on the **dedicated test account** (Requirement 2.7), never a real custodian. This is the "pilot in test" gate — a rehearsal that is removed at the end.

1. **Create the proof case.** `New-ComplianceCase -Name "eDiscovery Readiness – Proof – Pilot"

-CaseType eDiscovery (portal: **eDiscovery** → **Cases** → **Create a case**).
EDREADY-Remediation.ps1 -Commit` can create it.

1. **Place the proof hold on the test account.** Create `Readiness Hold Policy – Proof – Pilot`

(`New-CaseHoldPolicy` over the **test mailbox only**) and `Readiness Hold Rule – Proof – Pilot` (`New-CaseHoldRule`). `EDREADY-Remediation.ps1` builds these dry-run first; `-Commit` applies. Portal: case → **Holds** → **Create**.

1. **Run the proof search.** Create and start `Readiness Search – Proof – Pilot`

(`New-ComplianceSearch`/`Start-ComplianceSearch`) scoped to the test mailbox with a simple query matching the seeded content. Portal: case → **Searches** → **New search**.

1. **Confirm preservation.** As the test account, delete a seeded held item and confirm it remains

recoverable/preserved (recoverable items / preservation hold). This is the proof that a hold **actually preserves** in your tenant.

1. **Remove the proof hold (clean up).** Delete `Readiness Hold Rule – Proof – Pilot` then

`Readiness Hold Policy – Proof – Pilot` (`Remove-CaseHoldRule` / `Remove-CaseHoldPolicy`), leaving the tenant as it was. The **capability is proven; nothing is left preserving.**

Gate D (the core readiness gate): proof case created; hold placed and **proven** to preserve on the test account; scoped search returned the seeded items; proof hold **removed**. Fail any → the capability is not demonstrably ready — fix and re-run before claiming readiness.

Stage E — Validate

1. Run the **testing procedures in** `05-testing.md` and `EDREADY-Validation.ps1` — every rubric

gate (R/H/S/P) must return **pass**, and the audit log must show the proof activity. `EDREADY-Reporting.ps1` produces the final evidence pack (scorecard, gap register closed-state, proof audit records).

Gate E: all validation gates pass; audit shows the proof case/hold/search. Fail → remediate and re-validate.

Stage F — Expand (operate for real)

1. **You are ready to run live matters.** With gaps closed and the proof passing, operate real

matters using the **eDiscovery Administration** solution — legal owning every determination. Re-run this assessment **periodically** (e.g. quarterly, and after a tenant/licensing change) so readiness does not drift.

Rollback (documented before you commit anything)

• **Proof hold:** delete `Readiness Hold Rule – Proof – Pilot` then `Readiness Hold Policy – Proof –

Pilot (Remove-CaseHoldRule / Remove-CaseHoldPolicy`) — it only ever covered the **test account**, so removal releases nothing real. This is a normal step of Stage D.

• **Proof case/search:** searches are non-destructive; `Remove-ComplianceSearch` and

`Remove-ComplianceCase` remove the rehearsal artifacts.

- **Role change:** `Remove-RoleGroupMember` to revert an added operator.
- **Audit log:** enabling auditing is not reverted (it is a readiness improvement); if you must,

`Set-AdminAuditLogConfig -UnifiedAuditLogIngestionEnabled $false` — **not recommended.**

5. Testing & Validation — eDiscovery Readiness Assessment (Microsoft Purview)

Run these to **validate readiness** after remediation and the readiness proof. Each test maps to a rubric domain (**R/H/S/P**), states the **procedure** and the **expected pass/fail**, and where noted is produced by `EDREADY-Validation.ps1` / `EDREADY-Reporting.ps1`. The proof artifacts are the Section 1 names on the **test account**.

Test 1 (R) — Roles are least-privilege, with coverage

Procedure: Run `EDREADY-Validation.ps1`; or Purview → **Settings** → **Roles & scopes** → check **eDiscovery Manager** / **eDiscovery Administrator** membership. **Pass:** Operators are in eDiscovery Manager; a small lead group is in eDiscovery Administrator; **no Global Admin** appears in either group; ≥ **2** trained operators (coverage). **Fail:** Global Admin is used for matters, no members in the role groups, or a single operator (no coverage) — see Requirement 2.2 / Implementation Stage C.

Test 2 (H) — Unified audit log is on

Procedure: Run `EDREADY-Validation.ps1` (reads `UnifiedAuditLogIngestionEnabled`); or Purview → **Audit** returns results. **Pass:** Auditing is **enabled**; a search for recent activity returns records. **Fail:** Auditing off (high-severity gap — enable via `EDREADY-Remediation.ps1 -Commit`, Requirement 2.3).

Test 3 (H) — A hold actually preserves (the readiness proof)

Procedure: With `Readiness Hold Policy – Proof – Pilot` / `Readiness Hold Rule – Proof – Pilot` **enabled** on the **test account**, delete a seeded held item and confirm it is still recoverable/preserved. `EDREADY-Validation.ps1` confirms the proof policy/rule are enabled over the test mailbox. **Pass:** The hold policy/rule are enabled over the test mailbox and the deleted item remains preserved and discoverable — preservation demonstrably works. **Fail:** Hold shows disabled/error, or the item is permanently gone (see Troubleshooting) — the capability is **not** proven.

Test 4 (H) — Proof hold removed (clean up verified)

Procedure: After the proof, run `EDREADY-Validation.ps1` (or `Get-CaseHoldPolicy`) and confirm `Readiness Hold Policy – Proof – Pilot` no longer exists. **Pass:** The proof hold and rule are gone; nothing is left preserving on the test account. **Fail:** The proof hold still exists (remove per Implementation Step 13 / Rollback) — a rehearsal must not leave a standing hold.

Test 5 (S) — Scope/coverage is complete

Procedure: Run `EDREADY-Scope.ps1`; review workload coverage, **inactive/legacy mailboxes**, and that **Teams messages (in mailboxes)** and **M365 Group/Teams sites** are accounted for. **Pass:** Every in-scope workload is discoverable and mapped; inactive mailboxes are inventoried; no known workload is missing from the scope note. **Fail:** A workload is unaccounted for (e.g. Teams chat, M365 Group sites, inactive mailboxes) — a coverage blind spot (Requirement 2.4 / Implementation Step 2).

Test 6 (S) — Proof search returns the seeded content

Procedure: Inspect `Readiness Search – Proof – Pilot` statistics (`EDREADY-Reporting.ps1` or portal search **Statistics**); preview a sample. **Pass:** Item count is in the expected order of magnitude for the seeded test content; preview shows the on-topic seeded items — search over the held location works. **Fail:** Zero hits when content was seeded, or an implausible count (query/location scope wrong).

Test 7 (P) — Process artifacts exist

Procedure: Confirm the **matter-intake template** (with named legal owner + hold instruction), the **naming standard**, the **change-control/rollback**, and the **evidence-pack** routine are adopted. **Pass:** All four process artifacts exist and are owned; a matter could be intaken today with legal sign-off before configuration. **Fail:** Any missing — an org with tooling but no process is **not ready** (Requirement 2.5 / Implementation Step 8).

Test 8 (all) — Audit trail of the proof present

Procedure: Run `EDREADY-Reporting.ps1` (audit section) or Purview → **Audit** and search for the proof case/hold/search activity. **Pass:** Audit records exist for the proof case creation, hold placement/removal, and search — defensibility evidence is being captured. **Fail:** No audit activity (auditing off — Test 2 — or insufficient time to populate).

Test 9 — Licensing/tier recorded honestly

Procedure: `EDREADY-Discovery.ps1` case-type/tier signals vs the licensing in Requirement 2.1. **Pass:** The scorecard records the actual tier (Standard vs **Premium/E5**); any Premium *review* readiness claim is backed by E5 licensing. **Fail:** The scorecard claims Premium review readiness without the tier — **verify in your tenant** and correct.

Validation gate summary (all must pass to declare readiness)

- Roles least-privilege **with coverage**, no Global Admin (Test 1)
- **Audit log on** (Test 2)
- **Hold proven** to preserve on the test account (Test 3) and **proof hold removed** (Test 4)
- **Scope/coverage complete** — Teams, M365 Groups, inactive mailboxes (Test 5)
- Proof **search** returns seeded content (Test 6)
- **Process artifacts** adopted (Test 7)

- **Audit trail** of the proof present (Test 8)
- **Tier/licensing** recorded honestly (Test 9)

6. Troubleshooting — eDiscovery Readiness Assessment (Microsoft Purview)

Common readiness failure modes, what causes them, and how to resolve — keyed to the four domains and the named proof artifacts. Re-run the read-only scripts (`EDREADY-Discovery.ps1`, `EDREADY-Scope.ps1`, `EDREADY-Validation.ps1`) after each fix to confirm the gate flips to pass.

Unified audit log is OFF (high-severity H gap)

- **Symptom:** `EDREADY-Discovery.ps1` / `EDREADY-Validation.ps1` report

`UnifiedAuditLogIngestionEnabled = False`; the Audit solution returns nothing.

- **Cause:** Auditing was never enabled, or was disabled. Without it, preservation actions cannot be

proven — the defensibility evidence does not exist.

- **Resolve:** `EDREADY-Remediation.ps1 -EnableAudit -Commit` (or Purview → **Audit** → **turn on**). Then

wait — events take time to populate; re-run validation later. Enabling auditing is a one-way readiness improvement; do not disable it.

No members in the eDiscovery role groups / matters run as Global Admin (R gap)

- **Symptom:** `eDiscovery Manager` / `eDiscovery Administrator` show `(no members)`, or the discovery

script flags a member who is **also a Global Admin**.

- **Cause:** eDiscovery access was never delegated, or was granted via Global Admin (over-privileged).
- **Resolve:** Add operators with `EDREADY-Remediation.ps1 -AddManagers <upns> -Commit` and the

lead(s) with `-AddAdministrators <upn> -Commit`; remove standing Global-Admin use for matters. Grant eDiscovery **only** through the role groups.

Only one trained operator (coverage gap, R)

- **Symptom:** Validation flags fewer than two `eDiscovery Manager` members.
- **Cause:** Single point of failure — one person on leave stops a hold.
- **Resolve:** Add and **train** at least a second operator; document who does what. Coverage is part

of readiness, not just having *a* role holder.

The readiness-proof hold does not preserve (H — the core proof fails)

• **Symptom:** `Readiness Hold Policy – Proof – Pilot` shows disabled/error, or a deleted seeded item

on the **test account** is permanently gone (Test 3 fails).

• **Cause:** The hold was not enabled, the policy did not target the test mailbox, replication had not

completed, or the account is unlicensed for the hold.

• **Resolve:** Confirm the policy/rule exist and are **enabled** over the **test mailbox**

(`Get-CaseHoldPolicy`/`Get-CaseHoldRule`); allow time for the hold to take effect before deleting a test item; verify the test account's licensing. Rebuild with `EDREADY-Remediation.ps1 -BuildProof -ProofMailbox <test> -Commit` if needed. Do **not** conclude readiness until preservation is proven.

Proof hold still present after the assessment (H — cleanup gap)

• **Symptom:** Post-assessment, `Readiness Hold Policy – Proof – Pilot` still exists (Test 4 fails).

• **Cause:** The Stage-D cleanup step was skipped.

• **Resolve:** Remove it — `Remove-CaseHoldRule 'Readiness Hold Rule – Proof – Pilot'` then

`Remove-CaseHoldPolicy 'Readiness Hold Policy – Proof – Pilot'`. A rehearsal must not leave a standing hold; it only ever covered the test account, so removal releases nothing real.

Inactive / legacy mailboxes not covered (S blind spot)

• **Symptom:** `EDREADY-Scope.ps1` lists inactive mailboxes; the scope note does not account for them.

• **Cause:** Inactive/legacy mailboxes are a classic preservation blind spot — content persists but is

easy to forget.

• **Resolve:** Inventory every inactive mailbox and confirm whether it is in scope; ensure in-scope

ones would be covered by a hold. Record the decision in the scope note (a legal/records call on what is in scope).

Teams / M365-Group content missing from scope (S gap)

• **Symptom:** The scope note covers mailboxes but not **Teams chat**, **Teams files**, or **M365

Group** sites; a collection would under-collect.

• **Cause:** A mailbox-only mental model. **Teams chat lives in mailboxes**; **Teams files and M365

Group content live in SharePoint/OneDrive.**

• **Resolve:** Add Teams (chat via mailboxes) and M365 Group/Teams sites (SharePoint/OneDrive) to the

scope note and confirm they are discoverable in the portal — **verify in your tenant.**

Premium features (custodians / review sets / analytics / export) absent (tier)

- **Symptom:** You cannot create custodians or review sets; Premium readiness cannot be claimed.
- **Cause:** The tenant/operators are licensed for **Standard** only; Premium requires **E5 / E5 eDiscovery and Audit** (Requirement 2.1).
- **Resolve:** Record the **actual tier** in the scorecard (do not claim Premium review readiness without it). If a Premium review workflow is required, assign the licensing, then re-assess. **Plan names and gating change — verify in your tenant.**

Process artifacts missing (P — "tooling but not ready")

- **Symptom:** No matter-intake template, no legal sign-off gate, no naming standard, no change control/rollback, no evidence-pack owner (Test 7 fails).
- **Cause:** Readiness was treated as purely technical.
- **Resolve:** Adopt the four process artifacts (documentation deliverables). An org with perfect tooling but no intake/sign-off process is **not ready** — scope and holds are legal determinations that must be captured *before* configuration.

PowerShell connect / module errors

- **Symptom:** `Connect-IPPSSession` or `Connect-ExchangeOnline` fails; cmdlets not found.
- **Cause:** Module not installed, or legacy/basic auth.
- **Resolve:** `Install-Module ExchangeOnlineManagement -Scope CurrentUser`; connect with **modern auth/MFA**. For Premium signals also** `Install-Module Microsoft.Graph.Security`**.** Never** store credentials or app secrets in the scripts (Requirement 2.6).

Insufficient role to read config

- **Symptom:** Discovery/scope scripts report "could not read" for audit config, mailboxes, or role membership.
- **Cause:** The assessor lacks the Purview/Exchange role to read that object.
- **Resolve:** Grant the least-privilege read role (category GR #2 / Requirement 2.2) and re-run — do not escalate to Global Admin to work around it.

Government cloud paths differ

- **Symptom:** Portal paths/hosts in this guide do not match your tenant.
- **Cause:** GCC High / DoD use different hosts (e.g. `*.office365.us`) and some features lag Commercial.

• **Resolve:** Use your cloud's portal host and **verify in your tenant**; the cmdlets are the same,

the paths and availability may differ.

7. Best Practices — eDiscovery Readiness Assessment (Microsoft Purview)

Durable practices for keeping the eDiscovery capability **ready, least-privilege, and defensible** — so the next real matter is routine, not a scramble.

Readiness is a state you maintain, not a project you finish

• **Re-assess periodically.** Readiness drifts — people leave the role groups, licensing changes,

new workloads appear. Re-run this assessment **quarterly** and after any tenant/licensing change, re-scoring R/H/S/P and updating the gap register.

• **Track the scorecard over time.** A rising number of Ready domains (and a shrinking gap register)

is the evidence of a maturing capability; show it to legal and leadership.

• **Rehearse before you need it.** Run the **readiness proof on the test account** at least once per

assessment cycle. A team that has placed a hold and run a search this quarter responds faster when a real hold lands.

Least privilege and coverage (domain R)

• **Grant eDiscovery through the role groups, never Global Admin.** eDiscovery can read anyone's mail

and files; operators belong in **eDiscovery Manager**, a small lead group in **eDiscovery Administrator** — Global Admin is not an eDiscovery role.

• **Avoid the single point of failure.** Keep **at least two** trained operators; document who does

what. One person on leave should not stop a hold.

• **Consider compliance boundaries early.** In multi-region/multi-agency tenants, decide *before* a

matter whether an eDiscovery team may search everyone — the boundary is a legal/HR determination implemented as a compliance security filter.

Preservation you can prove (domain H)

• **Keep the unified audit log on — always.** It is the defensibility evidence; auditing off is the

single highest-severity readiness gap. Do not disable it.

• **Prove, don't assume.** "We have holds" is not readiness; "we placed a hold on a test account,

deleted a held item, and it survived" is. The proof is the point.

• **Cover the easy-to-miss data. Inactive/legacy mailboxes**, litigation-hold state, and the

retention-vs-hold interplay are where preservation silently fails — inventory and verify them.

• **Understand headroom.** Know the practical limits on the number/size of holds you may run, so a large matter does not surprise you.

Complete scope (domain S)

• **Remember where content really lives. Teams chat is stored in mailboxes**; **Teams files** and **M365 Group** content live in SharePoint/OneDrive. A mailbox-only mental model under-collects.

• **Account for unindexed/partially-indexed items and imported/third-party data** in the scope note — they do not vanish because a search missed them.

• **Map, then verify.** A written scope note is necessary but not sufficient; confirm the workloads are actually discoverable in the tenant.

Process and defensibility (domain P)

• **Legal owns the determination; IT executes and evidences it.** Scope, custodians, holds, and production are legal/records decisions. Readiness means the **intake step** captures that sign-off *before* configuration — never improvise scope.

• **Name everything to a standard.** A consistent naming convention (`<Purpose> – <Matter> – <Stage>`) makes matters auditable and the audit trail legible.

• **Change control and rollback for holds and exports.** Even a test hold is a production change; every hold/export has an approver, a pilot gate, and a documented rollback.

• **Own the evidence pack.** Decide who keeps the audit trail and export reports, and for how long — the evidence of a defensible collection is only useful if someone retains it.

Safe automation

• **Dry-run first, commit deliberately.** The remediation script is `-WhatIf` **by default**; read every previewed action before `-Commit`. Discovery/scope/validation/reporting are **read-only**.

• **Modern auth, no secrets.** Connect with `Connect-IPPSSession` / `Connect-ExchangeOnline` using modern auth/MFA; **never** put credentials or app secrets in scripts.

• **Keep docs and automation in lockstep.** The scripts print the same artifact names used in the Implementation and Testing guides — when you change a name, change it in both.

Know the boundaries

- **Verify licensing/tenant, don't assume.** Premium (custodians/review sets/analytics/export) is

E5-gated and the portal evolves; record the actual tier and flag version-dependent paths.

- **Government clouds differ.** GCC High / DoD use different hosts and some features lag — verify.
- **This assessment makes you ready; it does not run matters.** Operate real matters with the

eDiscovery Administration solution, with legal in control of every determination.

8. Deliverables Summary — eDiscovery Readiness Assessment (Microsoft Purview)

Documentation

- **01 – Solution Overview** — what a readiness assessment is (and how it differs from operating

matters via the eDiscovery Administration solution), why readiness is the risk, the four-domain rubric (**Roles / Holds / Scope / Process**), the assessment model, the reference naming for the readiness proof, and what legal owns.

- **02 – Requirements Guide** — the solution-specific prerequisites (eDiscovery tier/licensing,

least-privilege assessor roles, audit log, data-source + inactive-mailbox scope, named legal owner + intake, modules, a dedicated **test account** for the proof, change control) with Verify / Implement steps and a checklist — referencing the six shared **Purview category Global Requirements**.

- **03 – Implementation Guide** — the ordered **Assess → Design → Configure → Pilot (readiness proof

in test) → Validate → Expand **build: inventory current state, score R/H/S/P into a** scorecard + gap register**, remediate** dry-run first**, prove the capability** non-destructively on a test account** (case → hold → search → confirm preservation → remove hold), validate, then operate — with pass/fail gates and rollback.

- **05 – Testing & Validation** — nine procedures with expected pass/fail (roles least-privilege +

coverage, audit on, hold **proven** to preserve, proof hold **removed**, scope complete, search returns seeded content, process artifacts adopted, audit trail present, tier recorded honestly) and a gate summary.

- **06 – Troubleshooting** — common readiness failure modes and resolutions (audit off, no role-group

members / Global-Admin dependency, hold not preserving on the proof, inactive-mailbox coverage gaps, missing Teams/M365-Group scope, Premium features absent, proof cleanup).

- **07 – Best Practices** — durable practices for a ready, least-privilege, defensible capability that

is re-assessed and rehearsed rather than assumed.

- **Executive Summary** — the outcome (an evidenced answer to "are we ready?"), the approach, and why

it is low-risk.

PowerShell scripts (5) — safe-by-default (read-only or `-WhatIf`; modern auth; no secrets)

1. `EDREADY-Discovery.ps1` — **read-only current-state inventory.** Reports eDiscovery role-group

membership (Manager/Administrator, and whether Global Admin appears), existing cases / Content Searches / case-hold policies, unified-audit-log status, and case-type/tier signals — the raw evidence for the **Roles** and **Holds** domains.

1. `EDREADY-Remediation.ps1` — **gap remediation, dry-run (`-WhatIf`) by default.** Previews (and

with `-Commit` applies) enabling the unified audit log, adding named operators to the eDiscovery role groups, and standing up the **readiness-proof** case + hold on the test account (`New-ComplianceCase` / `New-CaseHoldPolicy` / `New-CaseHoldRule`). Never removes holds or members silently; prints every action.

1. `EDREADY-Validation.ps1` — **read-only rubric validation.** Runs the R/H/S/P gate checks — roles

least-privilege + coverage, audit on, proof hold enabled then removed, scope accounted for — and emits pass/fail for each, matching Section 5.

1. `EDREADY-Reporting.ps1` — **read-only scorecard / gap register / evidence pack.** Renders the

readiness scorecard and gap register and summarizes the proof search statistics, hold status, and eDiscovery audit activity — the deliverable evidence pack.

1. `EDREADY-Scope.ps1` — **read-only scope/health helper.** Reports mailbox coverage and

litigation-hold state, **inactive/legacy mailboxes**, existing retention holds, and the workload checklist (Exchange incl. Teams chat, SharePoint, OneDrive, Teams/M365 Group sites) — the **Scope/coverage** domain evidence.

All scripts print clear, named output referencing the same artifact names (`eDiscovery Readiness – Proof – Pilot`, `Readiness Hold Policy – Proof – Pilot`, `Readiness Search – Proof – Pilot`) used in the Implementation and Testing guides, so the docs and automation stay in lockstep. **Regulatory, records, and legal determinations are deferred to the relevant governance functions** — the scripts provide method and evidence, not the determination.

Appendix A — PowerShell Scripts

Included in the accompanying ZIP. Each script's header documents full usage.

EDREADY-Discovery.ps1

EDREADY-Remediation.ps1

EDREADY-Reporting.ps1

EDREADY-Scope.ps1

EDREADY-Validation.ps1